

STEFAN MALINOVIC

Senior Level Designer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Level Designer with 8 years across AAA, AA, VR, and free-to-play titles at **Ubisoft**, **RedSixteen**, **PlayStudios**, and **Welt Der Wunder**. Specialist in the full level design pipeline - blockout, metrics, pacing, player flow, sightlines, and environmental storytelling, from greybox to ship. Currently Senior/Lead Level Designer on Tales Edge (Unreal Engine 5), where I built the level design and world-creation pipeline from the ground up. Earlier level and mission design on Assassin's Creed Nexus VR and Riders Republic at Ubisoft. Fluent across multiple engines (Unreal, Unity, Anvil, Hammer) and a fast learner of new and proprietary toolsets. Native Serbian, fluent English.

CORE SKILLS

Level Design: Blockout & greybox, layout & spatial composition, player flow & pacing, sightlines & player guidance, metrics-driven design, mission & encounter design, combat / stealth / parkour space design, gating & progression, replayability, environmental storytelling

World Design: Open-world design, world-building, landmark & POI design, procedural content generation (PCG), level art collaboration

Engines & Tools: Unreal Engine 4 & 5, Unity, Anvil (Ubisoft proprietary), Hammer; Unreal Blueprints (advanced), Houdini (procedural), World Creator, Blender, Substance Painter, Zbrush, Perforce, Jira, Confluence

Production & Leadership: Pipeline & documentation ownership, validation gyms & playtest iteration, design reviews, mentoring, distributed-team collaboration, Agile / Scrum

Scripting: Unreal Blueprints, C#, Python, Lua, XML

AI Tools: Advanced user of: Claude Code, GPT, Gemini, and local models for rapid prototyping, documentation, and iteration

Languages: Serbian (native), English (fluent), Russian (basic), German (basic)

EXPERIENCE

RedSixteen Interactive | Belgrade / San Diego / Montreal (May 2024 - Present)

Sr. Level Designer (previously Studio Director, Lead Level Designer) - Tales Edge (Unreal Engine 5)

- Built the Level Design and World Creation pipeline from the ground up - blockout standards, validation gyms, metrics, design documentation, and procedural content generation; created 100+ maps, 4 public playable builds, and the trailer level.

- Lead level design for the game's combat, stealth, and parkour spaces - encounter layout, pacing, sightlines, cover composition, and player guidance that has to read in seconds; partner with the Game Design Director on how mechanics land in space.
- Design level flow and spatial pacing balancing challenge and player expression across multiple public playtests and the current First Playable level.
- Lead and mentor level designers and environment artists across a distributed international team (US, Canada, UK, Serbia); run design reviews and an iteration-first level pipeline.
- Set up the studio's Serbian branch - R&D, hiring, equipment, and worker contracts.

Welt Der Wunder e-lab (MILC) | Belgrade / Munich (*Jan 2023 - Mar 2025*)

Lead Designer (Game and Level) - MILC Metaverse - commercial real-time platform (UE4.27 to 5.4)

- Led a 9-person multidisciplinary team; owned feature design, world systems, and the Product Design Document and Art Bible.
- Designed interactive systems with embedded business logic for commercial clients including Marc Cain, Karl Lagerfeld, Lufthansa, Red Bull, Swarovski, Cannes Film Festival and Oldenburg Film Festival and many others.
- Translated commercial briefs into engaging spatial and systemic experiences that guided users toward defined goals.
- Personally created all recent overhaul 3D assets, from concept to finish and optimized them for browser use.

PlayStudios | Belgrade / Tel Aviv / Las Vegas (*Aug 2022 - Apr 2023*)

Technical Artist - Tetris (free-to-play mobile)

- Worked on a free-to-play mobile title, bridging design, art, programming, and UX in a 20-person studio under Tetris Co. licensing.
- Built the visual asset pipeline and implemented gameplay logic (C#, Lua, XML); gained direct free-to-play mobile production experience.

Ubisoft | Belgrade / Annecy / Montpellier / Düsseldorf (*Oct 2020 - Aug 2022*)

Level Designer - Riders Republic, Assassin's Creed Nexus VR (Anvil, Unity)

- **Riders Republic** (open-world): Owned all 45 in-world Landmarks and 11 named stunt challenges – route blockout, checkpoint placement, spatial pacing and difficulty tuning, technical scripting, and procedural foliage via Houdini. Contributed to the Showdown PvP arena layout and inter-zone metrics.
- **Assassin's Creed Nexus VR**: Designed mission levels and encounter spaces across 4 missions (2 owned) end-to-end parkour traversal layout, sightlines, AI placement, mission scripting, and set-piece systems (breakable assets, scripted events, VFX, audio) for Oculus Quest.
- Designed level content across AAA open-world and VR titles in proprietary (Anvil) and Unity engines, within distributed Ubisoft teams across four countries.

Ubisoft | Belgrade / Annecy (*Dec 2018 - Oct 2020*)

Development Tester and Level Designer - Steep, Steep DLC: Open Japan, Riders Republic (Anvil)

- Tested open-world systems, multiplayer arenas, and the prototype 4-team multiplayer mode on 400+ person AAA productions.
- Performed balance testing of multiplayer modes, risk assessment, and technical documentation across PC, Xbox, PlayStation, VR, and Switch.

INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

Self-directed products planned, designed, and shipped using advanced AI-augmented workflows trying to further expand my knowledge of systems design, gamification, free-to-play / freemium monetization, and end-to-end execution at speed:

- **Apps:** Qponko (privacy-first loyalty wallet - gamified UX, freemium, 38 languages), Waylo (intercity carpooling platform built on Telegram Infrastructure - freemium model), Lex Ardor (Serbian AI legal assistant), Spektrum Control (Fire Fighting Equipment inspection process automation and document digitalization), Wizard Buddy (Claude Code Extension for another PC)
- **Web platforms:** Triardor, Trisha Barber Shop, MBS Spektrum, Smokin' Hot (e-commerce).

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Laws (Hons), LL.B. - University of Megatrend (John Naisbitt), 2012-2016

Socio-Linguistic Diploma - Gymnasium Uros Predic, 2008-2011 (English, German, Russian, Latin)